



Radishes

CULTIVARS

- French Breakfast
- Easter Egg

INTENSIVE SPACING

- 12 rows (2" - 6 cm) per bed spaced every 2" (6 cm) on the row (for semi-long and fine radishes)
- 6-row seeder (C-M-N); Hole Size C, Middle pulleys, brush setting N

FERTILIZATION

- Radishes will do great in beds that were previously amended with compost and are fertilized with a mix of alfalfa meal (2-0-2) and pelleted chicken manure (5-3-2).

IMPLANTATION

For continuous supply of perfect small radishes, we seed them every week with an estimated 30% extra than our weekly need. Our spacings will allow for harvest over more than one week, but we usually aim to crop out the beds as we go.

In our program, radishes are seeded alongside hakurei turnips, arugula, and other baby Asian greens, all crops that will stay in the field for less than 45 days and that belong to the brassicaceae family. They therefore have the same fertilization and plant protection requirements.

EQUIPMENT

- Rotary harrow
- 6-row seeder, scale, notepad and your seeds
- 30" rake
- Anti-insect netting (or row cover in the spring and late fall)

ITINERARY

- Remove tarp and clean any large debris. Use the rake if needed. *
- Uniformly apply amendments and pass with the rotary harrow at a depth of 1" (3 cm). Rake the bed carefully, removing all debris; soil clods, rocks, roots, etc. Beds need to be perfectly clean, leveled and firm for optimal usage of the 6-row seeder.
- Only seed when the bed surface is dry (if not, seeds will stick, and the seeder won't work properly). It's good practice to roll over the seed bed with the 6-row (without any seeds) in order to firm up the seed bed and to make sure that it won't clog.
- Before seeding, take time to carefully adjust the 6-row seeder. To minimize uncertainty, we don't play with the whole size, nor do we adjust the depth of the planting. The brush, however, should be adjusted every time you seed.
- The gap under the brush (T - tight, N - normal, L - loose) should always be less than half the size of the seed being sown. For radishes, we set it to N. To adjust the brush, turn it clockwise to open it more, or counterclockwise to close it.
- To make sure that all six hoppers feed at the same rate, fill all of them with the exact same amounts of seeds. After seeding halfway in your first pass, adjust the brushes until all six are feeding at the same rate.
- Once seeding is complete, cover with the anti-insect netting, install irrigation and water until the soil is deeply moistened.

* If the previous crop is too well established, or if the bed is too messy, mow the crop as low as possible and harrow at a depth of 2" (5 cm). Add 1" (2.5cm) of compost evenly spread on the whole width of the bed and transplant into compost following a no-till strategy.

WEEDING

- Radishes are cultivated using the flex tine weeder 12-14 days after direct seeding, or when weeds are at the filament/cotyledon stage. They are cultivated only once because subsequent weeds won't have enough time to go to seed before the bed is cropped out and turned over.

PLANT PROTECTION

- To protect the crop against flea beetles, cover the bed with anti-insect netting (or row cover) immediately after seeding.
- This practice is even more effective if the seed bed is irrigated before installing the netting, as the water will chase away the flea beetles. The more tightly the sides are sealed, the better the results will be.

HARVEST

- Radishes are harvested with their tops and bunched in the fields in a kneeling position.
- One person harvests several rows at a time, pulling the largest radishes (or the smallest ones, depending on the growth stage of the crop), bunching only the nicest ones. Only those that are the right size, free of blemishes and without splits are taken.
- We aim to have bunches of +/- 15 radishes of sizes varying from 1.5" to 2" (4-5 cm)
- Make piles of 5 bunches in the aisles. When there are quite a few piles on the ground, someone picks them up and counts them into harvest totes.
- 1 person should harvest 80 bunches per hour.

CONDITIONING

- Radishes are washed using a pressure gun. Upon arriving from the fields, the harvest crates are placed to the left of the sinks.
- The bunches are washed by gun one by one and piled on the right. Once the pile has reached a certain height, place bunches of a same cultivar in each storage bin and identify the bin.
- 1 person should wash and package at least 100 bunches per hour.

STORING

- Radishes are stored in cold room kept at 35°F (2°C)